

film review Holiday Horror

BOMBAY TO BANGKOK

Director: Nagesh

Kukunoor

Starring: Shreyas

Talpade, Lena Christensen

Do you know Shah Rukh Khan? No. Do you know Amitabh Bachchan? No. Do you know Ayesha Takia? No. Useless, pronounces the Bangkok uncle. That's pretty much how the viewer feels about a movie that ought to have stayed in Kukunoor's personal collection of home videos of holidays with friends. Talpade, Kukunoor's enterprising fast bowler in the riveting *Iqbal* and the acrobatic layabout in *Dor*, smiles widely and dances wildly as a cook who turns into a thief. Lena Christensen plays a Thai prostitute who becomes the object of



SMILES APART: Christensen and Talpade

his affection. But nothing, not even throwaway lines like this—"Why are you called Shekhar Singh Bhatvadekar? Because my father was a great fan of sardars"—can save this low-budget, low brow, poorly shot comedy.

Bangkok may be a great place for Kukunoor to recover from his usually intense movies but a great massage does not a movie make. Kukunoor's reputation as a filmmaker who

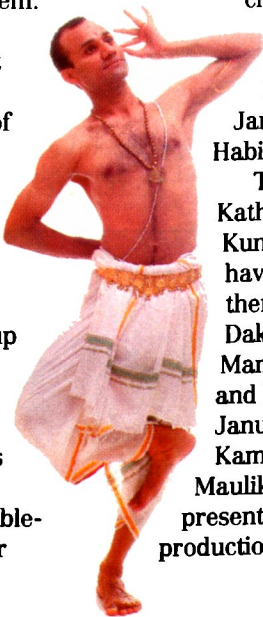
takes risks is one that has been hard-earned and in another era, he may well have had to subsist on NFDC's erratic largesse. But with easier finances, it's as easy to make films in Bollywood as it is to fritter away one's reputation. Here's a director who is the star of his movie. Viewers want his signature style, not David Dhawan having a really bad day.

by Kaveree Bamzai

recommendations Different Moves

DELHI Traditional Indian dance forms are considered feminine and men do not usually take to them.

But raised eyebrows haven't deterred Lokesh Bharadwaj, one of the finest male Bharatnatyam dancers today. A student of Bharatnatyam Justin McCarthy, Bharadwaj took up dancing along with an extensive practice of Asian martial arts in Mathura, Uttar Pradesh. The nimble-footed artiste later



moved to Delhi and made it his home. Watching Bharadwaj dance is a visual delight as he combines grace with a vigorous flourish. He performs the traditional repertory in-

cluding Thyagaraja kritis, Padams and Tilana. See him in action on January 31 at India Habitat Centre.

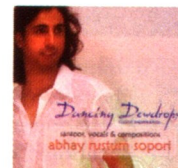
The disciples of Kathak guru Kumudini Lakhia have done well for themselves, be it Daksha Sheth, Aditi Mangaldas or Maulik and Ishira Shah. On January 29, at Kamani Auditorium, Maulik and Shah present a contemporary production called



IN STEP: Maulik and Shah; Bharadwaj (left)

Formatica. They explore complex forms as well as the rasa, bhava, abhinaya and sahitya of dance. "A dancer is always in search of physical and metaphysical forms, which can help him or her express the innermost essence of his art. *Formatica* is one such journey," says Shah.

music reviews Crossing Over



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DANCING DEWDROPS
Classical musicians who stuck to their instruments

are now crossing over and exploring their versatility and creativity by composing and singing differently, and experimenting with varying roles. Abhay Rustum Sopori, son of santoor maestro Pandit Bhajan Sopori, is one musician who fits this trend like a glove. In his new album, he collects melodies related to his memories of Kashmir. The album is based on ragas, but Sopori sings light melodies as well, making it a soothing compilation. But the singer could have included other voices for the sake of variety.



Eros

SUNDAY
Too many cooks spoil the broth, but this album retains its

melody despite having many music directors on board. *Missing Sunday* is composed by Sandeep Chowta, who experiments with new musical arrangements. In this song, Earl Edgar raps in a reggae style in Hinglish. Pakistani band Suroor does justice to the soulful alaap in *Pyar to hona hi tha*, which is sung with striking clarity. Daler Mehndi sings *Loot Iya* in a semi-classical style, mixing it with bhangra and lavni-style fusion music. Raghav Sachar's *Manzar* is classy and bears his distinctive style. An infectious album with a good mix of various musical forms.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit